

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

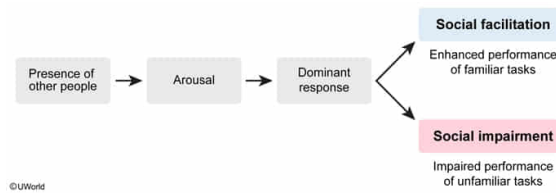
Which of the following best explains the role of social facilitation in accounting for the results of Study 2?

- ☐ A. Individuals perform more efficiently when they know they are being observed compared to when they know they are not being observed. [20%]
- ☐ B. Individuals prefer to perform familiar tasks in the presence of others but unfamiliar tasks when alone. [14%]
- ☐ C. An individual's performance is less predictable when acting in the presence of others than when acting alone.
- ✓ ☒ D. The impact that the presence of others has on an individual's performance depends on the nature of the task. [64%]

Correct

63% answered correctly

Explanation:



Social facilitation occurs when the **presence of others enhances performance**. This is thought to occur because the presence of an audience **increases autonomic arousal**, which causes the dominant (most easily elicited) response to occur. If a task is easy, well rehearsed, or familiar, arousal *improves* the performance of that task. For example, a basketball player scores more points in a game than during practice.

On the other hand, if a task is difficult or unfamiliar, arousal tends to *hinder* performance on that task (social impairment). For example, a novice basketball player is less likely to score a basket while others are watching.

The results of Study 2 suggest that the presence of others either enhanced or impaired performance, *depending on the nature of the task*. When participants did something easy and familiar (putting on one's own clothes), the presence of an observer enhanced performance. When participants did something novel and unrehearsed (putting on unfamiliar clothes), the presence of an observer impaired performance.

(Choice A) People do not *necessarily* perform more efficiently when being observed. Study 2 suggests that when people are being observed they perform easy tasks more efficiently and perform difficult tasks *less efficiently*.

(Choice B) Although the study did require some participants to perform alone and other participants to perform in front of an observer, the study did not examine the *preferences* of the participants.

(Choice C) Although the study analyzed performance both alone and with an observer, the results do not suggest that one condition led to behavior that was more *predictable*. Performance is equally predictable in either condition.

Educational objective:

Social facilitation is a phenomenon whereby the mere presence of others enhances performance on easy, well-rehearsed tasks. Social impairment occurs when the presence of others hinders performance on difficult or unfamiliar tasks. Both are partly due to the enhanced level of arousal caused by the mere presence of others.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID: 400825

System:

Identity and Social Interaction

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

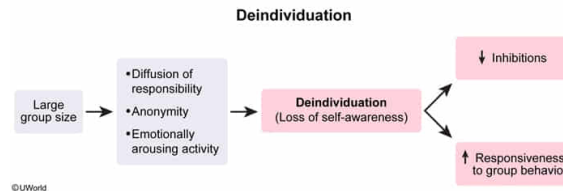
In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

A researcher in Study 1 believes the results are due to deindividuation. Is this conclusion justified?

- ✔ ☒ A. No, because races in which individuals are being timed do not impair personal responsibility. [57%]
- ☐ B. No, because bicycle races do not involve groups that are large enough to influence behavior. [3%]
- ☐ C. Yes, because large bicycle races induce feelings of anonymity among competitors. [29%]
- ☐ D. Yes, because team competition reduces one's sense of personal identity. [9%]

Explanation:

Deindividuation is a **loss of individual self-awareness** when one is part of a **large group** engaged in an emotionally arousing activity (eg, a large crowd at a sporting event). Members of large groups tend to feel a reduced sense of personal responsibility and an increased sense of anonymity. When identities are masked (eg, Ku Klux Klan robes), deindividuation is even more likely to occur.

Deindividuation results in reduced personal identity and inhibitions as identification with the group increases. This can lead individuals to engage in uncharacteristic behaviors (eg, rioting, looting) while part of a large crowd. Appalling group behaviors, like public lynching, are often attributed to deindividuation.

Competing in a large bicycle race is not likely to induce deindividuation among the racers. Even though the cyclists consist of a large group such that identifying individuals may be difficult, the racers still bear a sense of personal identity because they are trying to earn distinction by winning the race.

(Choice B) Groups of over 100 people are large enough for deindividuation to potentially occur. However, because this large group is engaged in a race in which individuals are trying to win in front of spectators, deindividuation is unlikely to occur due to the nature of the event, not because of the group size.

(Choices C and D) Being part of a large group of racers does not necessarily induce feelings of anonymity or reduced personal identity. Competitors are less likely to feel anonymous because they are racing for the distinction of winning.

Educational objective:

Deindividuation is a reduction in self-awareness when one is a member of a large group. Factors contributing to deindividuation include emotionally arousing activities, large group size, diffusion of responsibility, and anonymity. Deindividuation can result in negative crowd behavior (rioting, looting) that is usually uncharacteristic for those individuals.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 400826

System:
Identity and Social Interaction

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

Which of the following most accurately characterizes the two studies? Study 1 is interested in the impact of an audience on:

- ☐ A. impression management, while Study 2 is interested in the impact of an audience on role taking. [17%]
- ✓ ☒ B. front-stage behavior, while Study 2 is interested in the impact of an audience on back-stage behavior. [69%]
- ☐ C. primary group behavior, while Study 2 assesses secondary group behavior. [9%]
- ☐ D. message characteristics, while Study 2 assesses target characteristics. [4%]

Correct

69% answered correctly

Explanation:

Dramaturgical approach to understanding behavior	
Front-stage self	
• Behavior in social situations • "Actor" performs based on expectations of the "audience" • Impression management: meant to shape perceptions of others • Focus on appearance, manners & social status	
Back-stage self	
• Behavior in private • "Actor" can relax & no longer needs to perform • Behavior is spontaneous & free from evaluation or judgment by others	

The **dramaturgical approach** is a sociological theory suggesting that individual behavior can be explained using a theater metaphor. According to this theory, individuals behave as "actors" in front of others, the "audience."

The **front-stage** self involves **impression management**, which is the process of attempting to influence how one is perceived by others. For example, wearing a white coat and speaking with a soothing tone are ways a doctor uses front-stage behavior to manage the impression her patients have of her. The **back-stage self** involves behaviors that occur in private or informal settings, when an individual is completely comfortable and has no fear of criticism. For example, that same doctor might curse about one of her patients when she is out of earshot or is at home with her partner.

Study 1 assessed front-stage behavior (competing in a bicycle race), whereas Study 2 assessed back-stage behavior (getting dressed and undressed).

(Choice A) Role taking occurs when an individual behaves according to a social role (eg, mother, doctor); Study 2 did not involve the assessment of social roles or role taking behaviors.

(Choice C) Primary groups are composed of individuals who share close, informal, and enduring personal relationships (eg, families). Secondary groups are composed of individuals who come together to accomplish something (eg, coworkers). Studies 1 and 2 did not assess either primary or secondary group behavior.

(Choice D) Message and target characteristics describe how the receiver of a persuasive message might be motivated to listen to that message, according to the elaboration likelihood model of persuasion. Neither of the two studies assessed persuasion.

Educational objective:

According to the dramaturgical approach, front-stage behavior is similar to acting on a stage for an audience. It involves impression management (behaviors to shape how others perceive one) and presenting the most favorable image of oneself in front of others.

Back-stage behaviors are those done in private or informal settings, without fear of

criticism.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:400827

System:

Identity and Social Interaction

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

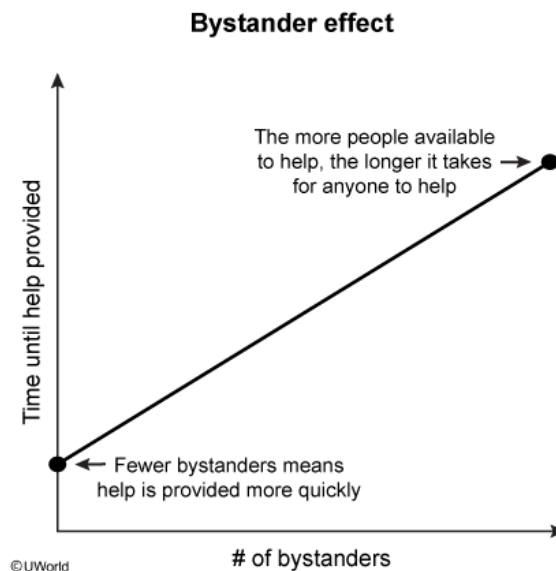
In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

Suppose the researchers in Study 1 wanted to analyze if the bystander effect occurs during bicycle races when racers get injured in accidents. To do this, which of the following data would they need?

- ☐ A. Racer's standing at time of accident and length of time between accident and assistance [6%]
- ☐ B. Racer's standing at time of accident and seriousness of racer's injuries
- ✓ ☒ C. Crowd size and length of time between accident and assistance [89%]
- ☐ D. Crowd size and seriousness of racer's injuries [3%]

Explanation:

The **bystander effect** is a phenomenon whereby individuals are less likely to help someone in need while in the **presence of others**. The more people present, the less likely anyone is to offer assistance. This is partly explained by **diffusion of responsibility**, the tendency for people in groups to assume someone else will do something. In other words, everyone assumes someone else will step in (diffusion of responsibility), so no one ends up taking any action (bystander effect).

In order for the researchers in Study 1 to analyze if the bystander effect occurs during bicycle races when a cyclist is injured in an accident, they would need to assess the size of the crowd and the length of time between the accident and the assistance. The bystander effect would predict that the larger the crowd, the longer it would take for a fallen cyclist to receive help.

(Choice A) The bystander effect is influenced by the number of bystanders who witness a scenario in which someone needs help, which is not dependent on the fallen cyclist's standing in the race.

(Choice B) The bystander effect would not be influenced by the seriousness of the cyclist's injuries as long as the cyclist is obviously in need of help.

(Choice D) According to the bystander effect, the larger the crowd the longer it would take for the fallen cyclist to receive assistance. However, as long as the cyclist is obviously in need of help, the seriousness of the cyclist's injuries has nothing to do with the bystander effect.

Educational objective:

The bystander effect refers to the fact that the probability of a bystander helping someone in need decreases as the number of bystanders increases. This can be partly explained by the diffusion of responsibility, whereby the bystanders assume that someone else will take responsibility for providing assistance.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:400828
System:
Identity and Social Interaction

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

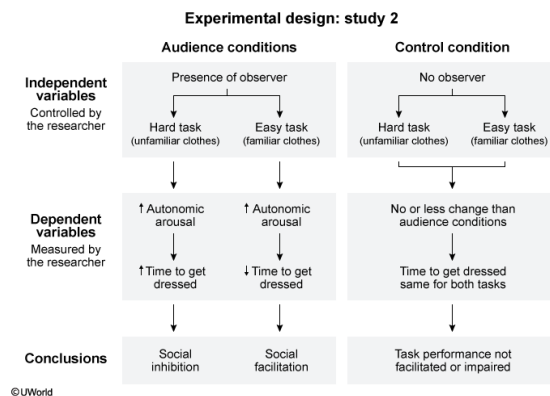
The researchers in Study 2 repeated the experiment, but also measured each participant's heart rate before and during the tasks. Which of the following is true regarding this new design?

- ☐ A. The presence of an observer is a dependent variable and autonomic arousal is an independent variable. [5%]
- ☐ B. The presence of an observer and autonomic arousal are both independent variables. [3%]
- ☐ C. The time taken to get dressed is a dependent variable and autonomic arousal is an independent variable. [8%]
- ✓ ☒ D. The time taken to get dressed and autonomic arousal are both dependent variables. [81%]

Correct

81% answered correctly

Explanation:



Every experiment has at least two types of variables: independent and dependent.

Independent variables are **manipulated/controlled** by the experimenter to determine if these changes impact dependent variables. **Dependent variables** are **measured or observed** by the researcher. Changes in the dependent variable determine whether the research hypothesis was confirmed and may inform future research.

In the new design for Study 2, an increased heart rate would serve as an indicator of autonomic arousal, stimulation of the sympathetic branch of the peripheral nervous system, which regulates the fight-or-flight response. Because social facilitation is thought to result partly from increased autonomic arousal (due to the presence of others), testing changes in heart rate helps clarify this relationship.

The new design for Study 2 includes two independent and two dependent variables. The researcher manipulates the presence or absence of an observer and task difficulty, so these are both independent variables. The researcher measures heart rate (autonomic arousal) and the time it takes to get dressed, so these are both dependent variables.

(Choices A, B, and C) The presence of an observer is controlled for by the researcher, so it is an *independent* variable. Time to complete the task and autonomic arousal (measured by heart rate) depend on the difficulty of the task and whether the participant is alone or with a confederate; therefore, they are both *dependent* variables.

Educational objective:

In scientific experiments, independent variables are manipulated by the researcher whereas dependent variables are observed/measured. Changes to the dependent variable are assumed to be caused by the independent variables.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 400829

System:
Identity and Social Interaction

For decades psychologists have known that people tend to execute tasks differently when alone compared to when in the presence of other people.

In Study 1, researchers analyzed records of bicycle racers' times both during competitions and when racing alone against the clock. They found that the fastest times were recorded during competitions, particularly larger races with over 100 cyclists. This finding was initially attributed to the competitive nature of the races, but later studies suggest performance improves when in the presence of other people, even outside of competition.

In Study 2, researchers conducted an experiment based on the idea that the mere presence of others impacts performance. This study involved a simple task (ie, getting dressed), which was performed either alone or with an audience. This task was chosen because it was familiar and routine, without clear standards of good or bad performance. Furthermore, the participants had no idea that this task was of interest to the experimenters.

Forty-five male undergraduate students were recruited for Study 2. The researchers informed the participants that they were required to remove their socks and shoes and replace them with unfamiliar ones and then put on a lab coat, surgical mask, and protective eye glasses (hard task). After a 10-minute wait, the participants were informed that the study was called off because the remaining participants failed to arrive and they could put back on their familiar clothes (easy task).

All participants in Study 2 were randomly assigned to one of three experimental conditions. In the *audience* condition, each participant performed both tasks in a room with an attentive confederate watching. In the *incidental audience* condition, a confederate sat facing away from each participant while the participant performed both tasks. The third group of participants performed both tasks alone (control condition). Participants' behavior was observed and timed by an inconspicuous researcher. It was found that, compared to controls, participants performed more quickly under both experimental conditions when putting back on their familiar clothing, and performed more slowly when dressing in unfamiliar clothing.

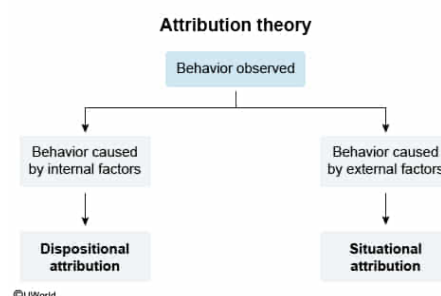
Both studies rely on which type of behavioral attribution?

- ☐ A. Dispositional [3%]
- ☐ B. Affective [3%]
- ✓ ☒ C. Situational [88%]
- ☐ D. Cognitive [4%]

Correct

89% answered correctly

Explanation:



Attribution theory suggests that individuals tend to explain behavior (their own or that of others) as resulting from internal or external causes. **Internal (dispositional)** attributions ascribe behavior to **personal factors**, such as personality, ability, or attitude. **External (situational)** attributions ascribe behavior to **environmental factors**,

such as task difficulty, presence of others, or luck.

Both studies conclude that the presence of other people, which is an external environmental factor, results in the observed behavior. Therefore, both studies rely on situational attributions.

(Choice A) Dispositional attributions assume that behavior is caused by personal traits such as temperament or intelligence. Both studies assess the impact of an external factor (presence of an audience) on behavior, so dispositional factors are not assessed or accounted for.

(Choices B and D) Neither affective nor cognitive attributions are explicitly part of attribution theory; however, both would still suggest that behavior is related to internal/dispositional factors (emotions, thinking) rather than external/situational factors.

Educational objective:

Attribution theory suggests that individuals attempt to explain behavior using internal/dispositional (eg, personality, ability) causes or external/situational (eg, environment) causes.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:400830

System:
Identity and Social Interaction